



**IN
PARTNERSHIP
WITH
PLYMOUTH
UNIVERSITY**

PUSL3134

Software Project Management 2026

20 CREDIT MODULE

ASSESSMENT: 50% Coursework 50% Exam

MODULE LEADER: Aruna Kooragamage

MODULE AIMS

- Understand Project Life Cycle: Gain knowledge about the phases of a software project, from initiation to closure.
- Resource Management: Learn how to effectively allocate and manage resources (people, time, and budget) to ensure project success.
- Risk Management: Understand how to identify, analyze, and mitigate risks to minimize their impact on the project.
- Improve Planning Skills: Master the creation of project plans, timelines, and schedules to ensure timely delivery.
- Quality Assurance: Ensure that the software developed meets the required quality standards through testing and review processes.
- Effective Communication: Learn to manage communication among stakeholders, team members, and clients to keep everyone informed.
- Stakeholder Management: Gain the ability to identify and manage the expectations and requirements of stakeholders.

- **Change Management:** Understand how to handle changes in project scope, timeline, or requirements effectively.
- **Time and Cost Management:** Learn how to manage project budgets and schedules to avoid delays and cost overruns.
- **Leadership and Team Coordination:** Develop leadership skills to motivate teams, resolve conflicts, and ensure productive collaboration.

ASSESSED LEARNING OUTCOMES (ALO):

Understand Project Life Cycle: Gain knowledge about the phases of a software project, from initiation to closure.

1. **Resource Management:** Learn how to effectively allocate and manage resources (people, time, and budget) to ensure project success.
2. **Risk Management:** Understand how to identify, analyze, and mitigate risks to minimize their impact on the project.
3. **Improve Planning Skills:** Master the creation of project plans, timelines, and schedules to ensure timely delivery.
4. **Quality Assurance:** Ensure that the software developed meets the required quality standards through testing and review processes.
5. **Effective Communication:** Learn to manage communication among stakeholders, team members, and clients to keep everyone informed.
6. **Stakeholder Management:** Gain the ability to identify and manage the expectations and requirements of stakeholders.
7. **Change Management:** Understand how to handle changes in project scope, timeline, or requirements effectively.
8. **Time and Cost Management:** Learn how to manage project budgets and schedules to avoid delays and cost overruns.
9. **Leadership and Team Coordination:** Develop leadership skills to motivate teams, resolve conflicts, and ensure productive collaboration.

Overview

This document contains all the necessary information pertaining to the coursework assessment of *PUSL3134 – Software Project Management*.

The sections that follow will detail the assessment tasks that are to be undertaken. The submission and expected feedback dates are presented in Table 1. All assessments are to be submitted electronically via the respective DLE module pages before the stated deadlines.

	Submission Deadline	Feedback
Coursework	22rd April 2026	XX XXX 2026

Table 1: Assessment Deadlines

All assessments will be introduced in class to provide further clarity over what is expected and how you can access support and formative feedback prior to submission. Whilst the assessment information is provided at the start of the module, it is not necessarily expected you will start this immediately – as you will often not have sufficient understanding of the topic. The module leader will provide guidance in this respect.

Tasks:

This assignment contributes to **50%** of the overall module mark for PUSL3134. It is a **group assignment** The groups must be formed of maximum 6 students, using the group selection activity on the DLE page for the module.

Coursework Description / Recommended Structure and Content of the Coursework

Notes: Main body sections can be structured/titled differently, as long as relevant information is included and there is a logical flow of information.

Assignment details: Group assignment to develop an e-commerce mobile application & e-commerce web application to sell Mobile Phones, Tabs and accessories. Each group need to obtain the prior approval for the assignment by submitting an abstract on or before **TBA**

Recommended Structure

- **Title Page**

- Title (relevant to sub-project task selected)
- Full name of authors
- Full details of Team numbers
- Date prepared

- **Table of Contents**

1. Introduction

- Why this document has been written
 - Brief description of the project
 - **Note:** *'Tone' of the document should be as if written by a project manager for a client (not as a student doing an assignment)*
- What is covered in this document?

2. Project Charter

- Use the **template provided**
- The following elements must be clearly stated
 - Purpose and objectives
 - Scope
 - Key requirements and acceptance criteria (quantified where appropriate)
 - Exclusions
 - Stakeholders
 - Total budget (should match budget developed in preliminary plan below)
 - Milestones dates (based on tasks and milestones in preliminary plan below)

3. Project Solution Architecture

- Context – Defines the scope of the system and the interactions with elements in its external environment

- Structure – Decomposes the system into discrete components and defines the interfaces between them
- Behaviour – Explains how the system responds to external stimuli, describing the needed behaviours that may span one or more Epics during implementation.
- System allocations – Allocates the system's resources (e.g., bandwidth, power, weight, space) to components
- Communications– Defines and communicates common interaction patterns between system components

4. Release Plan

Release Plan Process

First, lay out the goals for the release: what problem do we want to solve or how will we improve the user experience? Based on these goals, follow these steps to plan the release:

- Discuss the needed** features to address the goals.
- Discuss the details** involved in each feature, and factors that can influence delivery. This would include the infrastructure required, risk, and external dependencies. Features with highest risk and highest value should be planned early in the release.
- Decide how much work** you can commit to as a team, to finishing in each sprint. This is usually based on the team's velocity in previous sprints. You should take into account existing work on infrastructure or tools, and known interruptions such as support work.
- List the stories and epics** for the release in priority order with their size. An *epic* is a larger dev task broken down into several user stories.
- Add an iteration** to the plan.
- Add stories to the iteration** until it reaches the maximum capacity.
- Add more iterations** until all user stories are covered, or remove lower priority user stories to adapt to the required time frame for the release.

H. **Share the plan** using your agile management software (XL) and ask for feedback to get commitment from all team members, product owner and other stakeholders.

5. Kanban Chart

- Detailed Kanban chart diagram
 - A Kanban board is often summed up as the evolution of sticky notes and dry erase markers that keeps your team members informed of task assignments, due dates, and any other relevant information in one, easy-to-understand place.
 - With the amount of work that goes into any field, from software development to marketing, the benefits of using a Kanban board as a part of your project management strategy are great in number.

6. Project Plan using XL

- High-level tasks and milestones
 - Based on Release plan
- Attaché a soft copy of the MS-XL file.

7. Preliminary Budget

- Estimated cost for elements of project – at this stage high-level only
 - Labour
 - Based on effort
 - Taking into account skills required
 - Other overheads
 - Approvals and license fees
 - Management costs (e.g. your pay!)
- Justify (at a high-level) the estimated costs
 - Cite any references or other sources of information (e.g. quotes) used
 - Clearly state any assumptions used in estimating costs
- Identify high-level risks and/or potential sources of error related to budget

- State any contingencies built into the budget
- Clearly state final budget amount (reflected in charter)

8. Conclusion

- Summary of what has been done (key points)
- Overview of what remains to be done / next steps

9. Appendices

- Detailed information that will bog down reader / disrupt flow of information
 - Example: Estimation spreadsheets
- Appendices should be referred to in main text (so there is a connection)
 - E.g. “As shown in Appendix 2,”, or “..(refer Appendix 1 for details)”
- Each Appendix should have
 - a title
 - E.g. ‘Appendix 1: Effort Estimation Calculations’
 - A paragraph at the start explaining what is in the Appendix

10. References

- Harvard style of referencing
- Should only include references cited in-text

Deliverables and submission

You are required to write a report to cover the tasks in both Part 1 and Part 2 and a video demo recording to document the process. The **group** report should be no more than **4,000** words (excluding diagrams, images, tables, references and appendix). The submission should be organised as follows:

MARKING CRITERIA FOR THE PROJECT REPORT

Assessment – Software Project Management (Group Assignment- Individual Report Submission)		80 Marks
CONTENT		
• Introduction / Overview of the project		20 %
• Project Charter		20 %
• Solution Architecture		10 %
• Release Plan		10 %
• Kanban Chart		10 %
• Project Plan (XL)		10 %
• Preliminary Budget		05 %
• Conclusion		05 %
TOTAL		90 %
• DOCUMENTATION		20 Marks
• Structure and flow		05 %
• Referencing as per the standard		05 %
TOTAL		10 %
TOTAL FOR THE REPORT		100 %

Assessment Rubric

Criteria	Fail (<40%)	3 rd /Pass (40%+)	2.2 (50%)	2.1 (60%+)	1 st (70%+)	Grade
Introduction / Overview of the project	There is no clear, meaningful explanation of the Project.	Good overview of the setup, listing the components, but some missing elements	Good Project Introduction & overview but minimal explanations and details	Complete Project Introduction & overview	An excellent, Project Introduction & overvie with precise information	/20
Project Charter	Minimal evaluation and analysis of the Project	Evidence of evaluation and analysis of the Project	Systematic evaluation and analysis of the Project	In-depth evaluation and analysis of the Project highlighting the benefits and Values	Complete evaluation and analysis of the Project	/20
Solution Architecture	No evidence of meaningful project solution.	Evidence of meaningful project solution.	Evidence of a logical and coherent set of meaningful project solution	Clear evidence meaningful project solution	Excellent evidence of meaningful project solution.	/10
Release Plan	No clear layout the	Limited information for	Some level of information for	Good level of information for	Excellent and complete level of	/10

	goals for the release plan	the layout the goals for the release plan	the layout the goals for the release plan.	the layout the goals for the release plan.	information for the layout the goals for the release plan	
Kanban Chart	No clear information of task assignments, due dates, and any other relevant information	Limited information of task assignments, due dates, and any other relevant information	Some level of information of task assignments, due dates, and any other relevant information.	Good information of task assignments, due dates, and any other relevant information.	Excellent and very clear information of task assignments, due dates, and any other relevant information	/10
Project Plan (XL)	No clear High-level tasks and milestones Based on the Release plan	Limited High-level tasks and milestones Based on the Release plan	Some level of High-level tasks and milestones Based on the Release plan	Good High-level tasks and milestones Based on the Release plan	Excellent and very clear High-level tasks and milestones Based on the Release plan	/10
Preliminary Budget	No or poor Estimated cost for elements of project at high-level	Limited information on Estimated cost for elements of project at high-level	Some level of information on Estimated cost for elements of project at high-level	Good level of information on Estimated cost for elements of project at high-level	Excellent level of information on Estimated cost for elements of project at high-level	/05
Conclusion	No clear Summary of what has been done (key points) Overview of what remains to be done / next steps	Limited Summary of what has been done (key points) Overview of what remains to be done / next steps	Some level of information on the Summary of what has been done (key points) Overview of what remains to be done / next steps	Good level of information on the Summary of what has been done (key points) Overview of what remains to be done / next steps	Excellent level of information on the Summary of what has been done (key points) Overview of what remains to be done / next steps	/05
Structure and flow	Very poor quality of the Structure and the flow	Low quality of Structure and the flow	Some level quality of Structure and the flow	Good quality of Structure and the flow	Very Good quality of Structure and the flow	/05
Referencing as per the standard	No or missing Referencing as per the standard	Some missing Referencing as per the standard	Some level of quality in Referencing as per the standard	Good level of quality in Referencing as per the standard	Very Good level of quality in Referencing as per the standard	/05
Feedback/Overall	<i>Additional feedback</i>					/100

The report should have structure, i.e. it should contain table of contents, sections, and references. The Harvard referencing style is recommended. You should write your report as concisely as possible; it is important that you do not exceed or within 10% of the allowed word limit.

Submission must be on DLE, one report file, Microsoft Word format.

Assignment Feedback:

You will receive provisional mark and written feedback within 20 working days of the submission and presentation.

Notes:

- You must submit your coursework via the Digital Learning Environment portal. **Coursework must be submitted by the specified deadline.**
- You should give due consideration to your personal time management to ensure that coursework is submitted in plenty of time prior to the deadline.
- Coursework can be submitted at any time ahead of the deadline.
- Please note that work submitted late without valid extenuating circumstances will be penalized. Work submitted within 24 hours after the deadline will receive a mark, but it will be capped at the normal pass mark for that module. Work submitted more than 24 hours after the official deadline will receive an automatic mark of zero.
- The report that you present should be supported (where relevant) by appropriate evidence. Any such information that you present must be appropriately cited and referenced in your report - if you are unfamiliar with referencing style, then a Google search using the term 'Harvard referencing' will help to enlighten you. (Please refer the teaching and learning handbook for more details)
- Although you will be expected to make significant use of printed and online literature in researching and producing your materials, it is not acceptable for you to simply cut and paste material from other sources (small quotes are acceptable, but they must be clearly indicated as being quotes and the source must be referenced appropriately).

General Guidance

Extenuating Circumstances

There may be a time during this module where you experience a serious situation which has a significant impact on your ability to complete the assessments. The definition of these can be found in the University Policy on Extenuating Circumstances here:

https://www.plymouth.ac.uk/uploads/production/document/path/15/15317/Extenuating_Circumstances_Policy_and_Procedures.pdf

Plagiarism

All of your work must be of your own words. You must use references for your sources, however you acquire them. Where you wish to use quotations, these must be a very minor part of your overall work.

To copy another person's work is viewed as plagiarism and is not allowed. Any issues of plagiarism and any form of academic dishonesty are treated very seriously. All your work must be your own and other sources must be identified as being theirs, not yours. The copying of another persons' work could result in a penalty being invoked.

Further information on plagiarism policy can be found here:

Plagiarism: <https://www.plymouth.ac.uk/student-life/your-studies/essential-information/regulations/plagiarism>

Examination Offences: <https://www.plymouth.ac.uk/student-life/your-studies/essential-information/exams/exam-rules-and-regulations/examination-offences>

Turnitin (<http://www.turnitinuk.com/>) is an Internet-based 'originality checking tool' which allows documents to be compared with content on the Internet, in journals and in an archive of previously submitted works. It can help to detect unintentional or deliberate plagiarism.

It is a formative tool that makes it easy for students to review their citations and referencing as an aid to learning good academic practice. Turnitin produces an 'originality report' to help guide you. To learn more about Turnitin go to:

https://guides.turnitin.com/01_Manuals_and_Guides/Student/Student_User_Manual

Referencing

The University of Plymouth Library has produced an online Support referencing guide which is available here: http://plymouth.libguides.com/referencing_

Another recommended referencing resource is [Cite Them Right Online](#); this is an online resource which provides you with specific guidance about how to reference lots of different types of materials.

The Learn Higher Network has also provided a number of documents to support students with referencing:

References and Bibliographies Booklet:

<http://www.learnhigher.ac.uk/writing-for-university/referencing/references-and-bibliographies-booklet/>

Checking your assignments' references:

<http://www.learnhigher.ac.uk/writing-for-university/academic-writing/checking-your-assignments-references/>